# Questions to Ask Your Husband, the Kids and the People Who Already Help About How the Care Is Shared

Fifteen questions, sorted by who can answer them, with room to write what each person says.

Your daughter handles some things, your son handles others, and some you've simply picked up yourself. Nobody has ever been asked the same questions about it. Take these to each person in an unhurried moment, ask them as they are, and write the answer under each one.

Your own answers belong on the page too. Before you ask anyone else, write down what has gotten harder for you in the last year, and which tasks you couldn't keep doing the way you do them now.

This guide doesn't answer the questions and doesn't say which matters most. That depends on your husband and your family, and the people below are the ones who know.

## Your husband

His account comes first. Ask on an ordinary day, and write what he says the way he says it.

1. How do you feel things are going, day to day?

2. Is there anything you'd like done differently, or anything you'd rather keep doing yourself?

3. Is there something about all this you've been wanting to say to me or to the kids?

## The kids

Ask each of them separately, in the same words, so the answers can sit side by side.

1. Which things for Dad do you think of as yours?

2. Which things do you think I take care of, and which do you think someone else does?

3. What do you see getting harder for me that I may not have said?

4. Is there anything you offered to do that has turned out to be hard to keep up?

5. What is the one concern about Dad's care you'd most want us to talk about?

6. Is there something we see differently that you'd want us to talk through while there's time?

## The people who already help

A neighbor, a friend, a relative, or anyone else who does something for him on a regular basis.

1. What do you do for him, and how often?

2. If you couldn't do your part one week, who would you tell?

3. Is there anything you've noticed that you weren't sure whether to mention?

## His doctor's office

For anything on your list that is about his health. Ask with him there, and let him answer for himself.

1. We keep a list of things the family has noticed at home. Is any of it something you'd want to hear about?

2. When we have a question about day-to-day care at home, who in the office should we bring it to?

## Your care consultant

Someone who looks at the whole arrangement with you and the family, including how much is resting on one person.

1. Looking at our list of who does what, what would you ask us that we haven't asked ourselves?

**What this guide doesn't do**

It doesn't answer these questions, weigh one person's answer against another's, or say which question comes first. It puts the same questions to everyone, so the answers can sit on one page.

## Ready for the next step?

You have your questions, and a person for each one. The care interview gives the answers somewhere to go: it takes you through your husband's situation and the help around him area by area, and turns what you've gathered into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

**Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›**

### WHERE THIS COMES FROM

The note under “His doctor's office” follows the National Institute on Aging's tips for going to a doctor's appointment with someone. The questions and the grouping come from the Family Care Roadmap's working list for this step.

1. National Institute on Aging, Taking Someone to a Doctor's Appointment: Tips for Caregivers